

Days to ultimate high or low. Upward breakouts take an average of about 8 months to reach the ultimate high, but downward breakouts end faster, in about 2 months. The yardage traveled is different, though, because upward breakouts rise 43% and downward breakouts drop 15%. If you do the math, we find that the downward breakout should have reached bottom in 85 days, not 51. So, price dropped faster than it climbed.

How many change trend? I added this measure to help decide which chart patterns lead to outsized gains (a gain or loss of more than 20%). The results shown in the table are mid-list numbers. The upward breakout number is good (more than half the patterns see decent gains), but downward breakouts fall well short of a 20% loss (just 27% drop that far).

[Table 10.3](#) shows various failure rates for the two breakout directions. How do you make sense of the table? It is easier to understand by example. I found that 21% of the patterns with upward breakouts failed to see price rise more than 5%. Over half (51%) of the patterns failed to see price rise more than 25% after an upward breakout.

[Table 10.3](#) Cumulative Failure Rates

Maximum Price Rise or Decline (%)	Up Breakout	Down Breakout
5 (breakeven)	125 or 21%	77 or 23%
10	65 or 32%	72 or 33%
15	46 or 39%	50 or 59%
20	43 or 46%	45 or 73%
25	29 or 51%	29 or 81%
30	44 or 59%	21 or 88%
35	28 or 63%	15 or 92%
50	65 or 74%	17 or 97%
75	55 or 83%	9 or 100%
Over 75	101 or 100%	0 or 100%